Talking About Your IT Job: Responsibilities and Daily Tasks

CEFR: A2 | 90 min Vocabulary -> Useful sentences -> Reading -> Dialogue -> Discussion Change Reading into an exercide: hide the target vocab in the passage and request learner to select the correct one to fill in the blank Dialogue has 2 versions: (1) Show the full version (2) Show each sentence with the intents and suggest the structures they can use on the side-by-side column

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Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

- Discuss their job responsibilities using simple English.
- Describe their daily tasks and projects.
- Use 6 new vocabulary words related to IT work.
- Answer basic questions about their professional role.

Warmer (5-7 minutes)

Teacher asks:

1. "Hello everyone! To start, let's go around and share: What is one small thing you did at work this week that you found interesting or fun?"
2. "Or, what's your favorite part of your job?"

Learners share their answers, encouraging simple, short responses.

Vocabulary Focus

Here are 6 new words to help you talk about your job:

1. **implement (v)** /ɪmˈplɪmənt/

* **Definition:** To put a plan, design, or system into action; to start using something new.

* **Example:** We need to **implement** the new security update by next week.

2. **functionality (n)** /ˌfʌŋkʃəˈnælɪti/

* **Definition:** The range of different things that a piece of software or a system can do.

* **Example:** We are always improving the **functionality** of our mobile app for users.

3. **troubleshoot (v)** /ˈtrʌbəlʃuːt/

* **Definition:** To find and fix problems in a computer system or piece of equipment.

* **Example:** My job is to **troubleshoot** network issues and help clients.

4. **deploy (v)** /dɪˈplɔɪ/

* **Definition:** To make new software or a system available for people to use.

* **Example:** After testing, we will **deploy** the new application to all servers.

5. **interface (n)** /ˈɪntərfeɪs/

* **Definition:** The part of a computer program or system that a user sees and interacts with, often a screen.

* **Example:** We designed a simple and clear **interface** to make the app easy to use.

6. **resolve (v)** /rɪˈzɒlv/

* **Definition:** To find a solution to a problem or difficulty.

* **Example:** The team is working to **resolve** a critical issue in the system.

Language Focus: Useful Sentences

Here are 5 useful sentences to help you talk about your job:

1. My main responsibility is...

* **Intent:** To state your primary duty.

* **Example:** My main responsibility is to **implement** new security protocols.

2. I work on...

* **Intent:** To describe your current projects or areas of focus.

* **Example:** I work on improving the **functionality** of our main software.

3. A typical day involves...

* **Intent:** To describe what you usually do during your workday.

* **Example:** A typical day involves **troubleshooting** client issues and updating user **interface** designs.

4. One challenge is...

* **Intent:** To talk about a difficulty or problem in your job.

* **Example:** One challenge is to **resolve** complex network problems quickly.

5. I really enjoy...

* **Intent:** To express what you like about your job.

* **Example:** I really enjoy **deploying** new technologies and seeing them make a difference.

Main Activities

Activity 1: Reading - Fill in the Blanks (15 minutes)

Instructions: Read the text below about a Mobile Developer's job. Choose the correct vocabulary word from the box to fill in each blank. Each word can only be used once.

- implement *functionality* troubleshoot *deploy* interface * resolve

"Hi, I'm Sarah, a Mobile Developer. My main responsibility is creating and maintaining our company's mobile applications. A typical day involves writing new code to (1) _____ exciting features. For example, if users report a bug, I need to quickly (2) _____ the problem and push out a fix. We're constantly working to improve the overall (3) _____ of the app, adding new capabilities and ensuring smooth performance. When a new app version is ready, my team helps to (4) _____ it to the app stores for our users. I also often provide feedback on the user (5) _____ of new designs, ensuring it's intuitive and easy to use. Sometimes, I need to (6) _____ complex technical problems, especially after a new API integration or a major architectural change. I really enjoy bringing new ideas to life and making our app enjoyable for users!"

Answer Key:

1. implement
2. resolve
3. functionality
4. deploy
5. interface
6. troubleshoot

Activity 2: Dialogue (20 minutes)

Version 1: Full Dialogue

Instructions: Read the dialogue between two IT professionals talking about their jobs. Pay attention to the new vocabulary and useful sentences.

Mark (Systems Administrator): Hi Tom! How are things going?

Tom (Software Engineer): I'm good, Mark, thanks! Just finished helping **resolve** a critical bug in the latest release. What about you?

Mark: Oh, that's good. **My main responsibility is to deploy** new systems and ensure their stability. We're preparing to **implement** a major server migration next month.

Tom: Interesting! **I work on** developing new features and improving the overall **functionality** of our enterprise software.

Mark: Right. **A typical day involves** monitoring system performance, and then I often have to **troubleshoot** network issues. Sometimes **one challenge is to resolve** complex problems that impact many users.

Tom: I know that feeling! For me, **one challenge is to ensure** a user-friendly **interface** for all the new features. But **I really enjoy implementing** new code and seeing it work.

Mark: Me too! **I really enjoy deploying** new tech and seeing it make a difference. It's rewarding.

Tom: Absolutely. So, any big changes to the user **interface** coming up for the internal systems?

Mark: Yes, a new dashboard **interface** soon. It's a big project to **implement** by the end of the quarter.

Tom: Good luck with that! It sounds like a lot of work to **troubleshoot** any potential integration issues.

Version 2: Dialogue with Intents and Structures

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. This time, look at the intent of each sentence and the suggested structures you can use.

Speaker	Dialogue Line	Intent (What they are trying to do)	Suggested Structures (Language to use)
Mark	Hi Tom! How are things going?	Greet someone and ask about their well-being.	"Hi [Name]! How are things going?"

| Tom | I'm good, Mark, thanks! Just finished helping **resolve** a critical bug in the latest release. What about you? | Respond to a greeting and briefly mention a recent task, then ask back. | "I'm good, thanks! Just [past action]... What about you?" (Using vocab: "resolve") |

| Mark | Oh, that's good. **My main responsibility is to deploy** new systems and ensure their stability. We're preparing to **implement** a major server migration next month. | Share primary job duty and mention a current project. | "My main responsibility is to [verb] [noun]... We're preparing to [verb] [project]." (Using vocab: "deploy", "implement") |

| Tom | Interesting! **I work on** developing new features and improving the overall **functionality** of our enterprise software. | Describe specific area of work and goal. | "I work on [area of work] and improving the [noun] of our [software]." (Using vocab: "functionality") |

| Mark | Right. **A typical day involves** monitoring system performance, and then I often have to **troubleshoot** network issues. Sometimes **one challenge is to resolve** complex problems that impact many users. | Detail daily tasks and mention a common difficulty. | "A typical day involves [gerund], and then I often have to [verb]... One challenge is to [verb] [noun]." (Using vocab: "troubleshoot", "resolve") |

| Tom | I know that feeling! For me, **one challenge is to ensure** a user-friendly **interface** for all the new features. But **I really enjoy implementing** new code and seeing it work. | Acknowledge shared difficulty, mention own challenge, and express enjoyment. | "I know that feeling! For me, one challenge is to [verb] [noun]. But I really enjoy [gerund]..." (Using vocab: "interface", "implementing") |

| Mark | Me too! **I really enjoy deploying** new tech and seeing it make a difference. It's rewarding. | Agree with enjoyment and explain why. | "Me too! I really enjoy [gerund] new tech and seeing it make a difference. It's rewarding." (Using vocab: "deploying") |

| Tom | Absolutely. So, any big changes to the user **interface** coming up for the internal systems? | Express agreement and ask about future projects/features. | "Absolutely. So, any big changes to the [noun] coming up for [systems]?" (Using vocab: "interface") |

| Mark | Yes, a new dashboard **interface** soon. It's a big project to **implement** by the end of the quarter. | Confirm and describe an upcoming feature/project. | "Yes, a new [type] [noun] soon. It's a big project to [verb] by [time]." (Using vocab: "interface", "implement") |

| Tom | Good luck with that! It sounds like a lot of work to **troubleshoot** any potential integration issues. | Offer encouragement and comment on the perceived difficulty. | "Good luck with that! It sounds like a lot of work to [verb] any potential [noun]." (Using vocab: "troubleshoot") |

Activity 3: Discussion (20 minutes)

Instructions: Discuss the following questions with your classmates. Try to use the new vocabulary and useful sentences in your answers.

1. What is **your main responsibility** at work? (Can you use words like **implement** or **deploy**?)
2. Can you describe what **a typical day involves** for you? (Do you often **troubleshoot** issues?)
3. What kind of **functionality** is important in the software you use or develop?
4. Have you ever helped to **deploy** a new system or update? What was it like?
5. What do you do to **resolve** problems at work?
6. What makes a good user **interface**?
7. What do **you really enjoy** about your job? What is **one challenge** you face? (Can you use a new vocabulary word to describe it?)

Wrap-Up (5 minutes)

Teacher:

- "Great job everyone! Let's quickly review the new words and sentences from today."
- Teacher quickly shows the vocabulary words and useful sentences again.
- Teacher asks each learner: "Can you tell me one new thing you learned to say about your job today, using a new word or sentence?"
- Learners give a quick summary.

Homework

Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) describing your job. Include at least 3 of the new vocabulary words and 2 of the useful sentences from today's lesson. Be prepared to share it with the class in our next lesson.